

The Django Admin is behind a login wall, since you don't want just anybody modifying your data. A user marked as *staff* is allowed to log in to the Django Admin. What they can do inside the Django Admin is dependent on their permissions. A user marked as *admin* automatically has permission to do everything in the Django Admin.

django-admin, Django Admin, admins, and superusers

Django uses the word *admin* a lot—and to mean different things. As you might imagine, this can be a bit confusing.

Term	Meaning
django-admin	The management script used to create new Django projects
Django Admin	The web interface allowing administrators to manage <code>Model</code> objects
Admin	The permission level applied to users with unrestricted access to the Django Admin
Superuser	Another term for an admin user, mostly used in the <code>createsuperuser</code> management command

Personally, I've never built a Django site for which I bothered with the staff designation. For sites that are complicated enough to have varying permission levels, I typically find that I want more control over the interface than the Django Admin provides. In this case, I end up building my own pages for staff-type activities. The admin user, though, is quite valuable. You can go a long way in being able to manage your site without having to write very much code, using the Django Admin and admin users.

NOTE I will continue referring to *admin* in the singular, but it is a property of a user account. You can have as many users with admin permission as you'd like.

5.1.1 Creating an admin user

The Django Admin allows you to create and manage users, but you have a bootstrapping problem: you have to be able to log in to the Django Admin to use the Django Admin. To get around this, there is a management command for creating a user with admin privileges. The `createsuperuser` command asks you a few questions and gets you going:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py createsuperuser
Username (leave blank to use 'ctrudeau'): admin
Email address: admin@example.com
Password:
Password (again):
The password is too similar to the username.
This password is too short. It must contain at least 8 characters.
This password is too common.
Bypass password validation and create user anyway? [y/N]: y
Superuser created successfully.
```